



WILL PCS STAY?

Let's explore how the status-quo will change in the PC space

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When we consider PC components, we're mostly looking at the underlying silicon, be it within the CPU or within the graphics cards as the GPU. There's a different tale to be told about the ecosystem as a whole. We're going to look at the PC as a whole as well as the individual component manufacturers.

ONE FOR ALL

Over the last couple of years, we've seen more of the traditional component companies diversifying their portfolios. Motherboard vendors expanded to selling graphics cards and then added RAM sticks, CPU coolers, power supplies, monitors and slowly everything else. Soon after we got major manufacturers such as GIGABYTE, ASUS, MSI and the rest, manufacturing and selling every part of the PC.

However, not all the components made by the big brands have been great. A motherboard manufacturer has continued to make great motherboards, but the power supplies and other components they recently added have been sub-par. And that's always going to be the case. In the coming years, we'll see more of these sub-par components improve and become competitive. Then there are

the specialists, who make a few components and prefer to make nothing else. There's a good likelihood that they too will have to diversify their portfolios a little or risk running out of business with one bad year. Few brands who are usually aggressive had to scale back drastically owing to the slowdown of the industry because of the pandemic. Should this continue for a few more years, it could very well spell their doom, right?

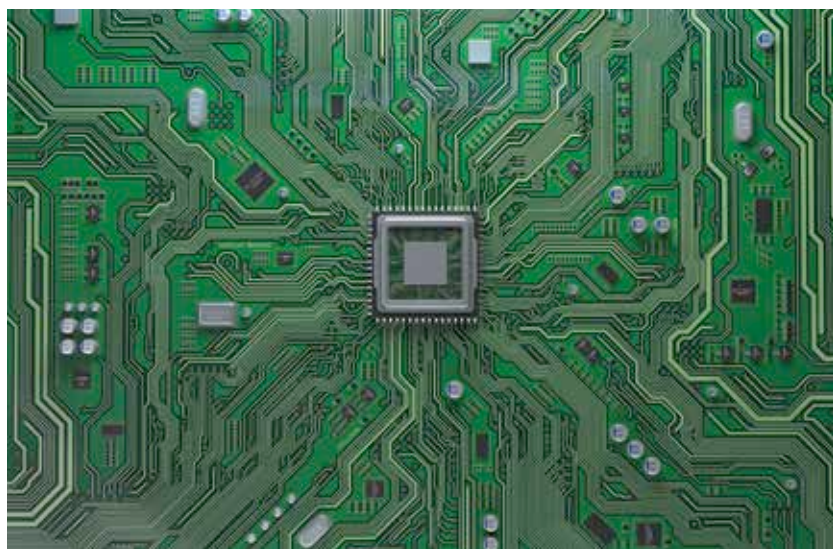
Well, not exactly. Brands have realised this and have started refactoring their products to become more service oriented. We'll start seeing subscription-based services baked into products. To be honest,

certain devices have already started moving in this direction. Networking devices such as wireless routers have implemented anti-virus applications and VPN services which are subscription-based.

The idea is to fight commoditisation by offering a service that sets the product apart. Which is why this move towards the service economy is very much required for the survival of these brands and we'll soon be inundated with products that offer services.

...AND ALL FOR ONE

Processors started off as being capable of running a certain fixed set



All roads lead to the CPU – just a gratuitous photo to show the complexity of modern hardware